

Word family: **formal / formally / formality / formalities / formalize / formalise / formalization / formalisation / informal / informally / informality**

Base word: formal

Comparative: more formal

Superlative: most formal

Related forms: formally, formality, formalities, formalize / formalise, formalization / formalisation, informal, informally, informality

Useful constructions/extensions: formal presentation, formal meeting, formal event, formal invitation, formal complaint, formal request, formal agreement, formal approval, formal education, formal qualification, formal language, formal writing, formal dress, formal occasion, formal procedure, formal system, formal proof, formal structure, mere formality, complete the formalities, formalize an agreement

Part of speech: mainly adjective (形容詞) / related adverb, noun and verb forms (相關副詞、名詞及動詞)

Your passage contains:

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever done was giving a **formal presentation** in English at a company event last year.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **formal** means that the presentation was **official, prepared, structured, and appropriate for a professional company event**, rather than casual or spontaneous.

You were speaking:

- * in front of around two hundred colleagues;
- * in front of senior managers;
- * as a representative of your team;
- * about a work project;
- * in a planned and professional setting.

So **formal** describes the **style and setting** of the presentation.

Meaning: Conducted in a serious, organized, professional way according to the expectations or conventions of an official occasion.

繁體中文： **按照正式場合的規範，以有組織、較嚴謹和專業的方式進行的，而不是隨意、輕鬆或臨時的**

中文翻譯：

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever done was giving a formal presentation in English at a company event last year.”

「我做過其中一件最具挑戰性的事情，就是去年在一個公司活動上**用英文作一場正式而有組織的簡報**。」

So:

formal presentation = 在正式 / 專業場合中，按照預先準備及較嚴謹結構進行的簡報

It does **not** merely mean:

> 「有禮貌的簡報」

and it does not necessarily mean:

> 「政府官方的簡報」

The idea is primarily:

not casual + structured + professionally appropriate

1. **formal + event/meeting/presentation (活動 / 會議 / 簡報) — 正式的；按規範進行的**

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Organized and conducted according to established professional, social, or institutional conventions rather than casually.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I gave a **formal presentation** in English at a company event.”

「我在公司活動上用英文作了一場**正式而有組織的簡報**。」

Practice 2

> “The managers held a **formal meeting** to discuss the issue.”

「經理們舉行了一次**正式會議**來討論這個問題。」

Practice 3

> “The award ceremony was a **formal event**.”

「頒獎典禮是一個**正式場合 / 正式活動**。」

****formal event/meeting/presentation = 按照正式場合的規範，以較嚴謹、有組織和專業的方式進行的活動****

2. ****formal = official and recognized by an organization (正式認可的) — 正式的；官方程序上的****

Here ****formal**** means something has been made ****official according to an organization's rules or procedures****.

Practice 4

> “We are waiting for ****formal approval**** from senior management.”

「我們正在等待高層管理人員的****正式批准****。」

Practice 5

> “The company made a ****formal announcement**** about the change.”

「公司就這項改變作出了****正式公布****。」

****formal = 經機構、組織或權責人士按照正式程序確認、批准或公布的****

Common:

- * formal approval
- * formal announcement
- * formal recognition
- * formal authorization
- * formal appointment

3. ****formal request/complaint/warning (正式要求 / 投訴 / 警告) — 正式提出的；按程序提出的****

This is an important workplace and administrative branch.

Practice 6

> “She submitted a ****formal complaint**** to human resources.”

「她向人力資源部**正式提出投訴**。」

Practice 7

> “The employee received a **formal warning**.”

「該員工收到了一次**正式警告**。」

****formal request/complaint/warning = 按照既定程序正式記錄、提出或發出的要求 / 投訴 / 警告****

This is stronger and more official than an ordinary conversation.

4. ****formal agreement/contract/arrangement (協議 / 合約 / 安排) — 正式確立的 ; 具正式效力的****

Practice 8

> “The two companies signed a **formal agreement**.”

「兩家公司簽署了一份**正式協議**。」

Practice 9

> “There was no **formal contract** between them.”

「他們之間沒有任何**正式合約**。」

****formal agreement/contract = 經正式程序建立、通常有明確條款或法律 / 機構效力的協議****

Contrast:

> an informal understanding

= 非正式默契 / 口頭共識

5. ****formal procedure/process (程序) — 按既定規則進行的****

Here the emphasis is on following an established sequence or institutional rule.

Practice 10

> “You must follow the **formal procedure** for making an appeal.”

「提出上訴時，你必須遵循**正式程序**。」

Practice 11

> “The matter will now go through a **formal review process**.”

「這件事現在會進入**正式審查程序**。」

formal procedure/process = 按照機構預先訂立的規則、步驟或程序進行的

6. **formal language/style** (語言 / 風格) — 正式語體的；較莊重的

This is a major language-learning meaning.

Meaning: Using vocabulary, grammar, and tone appropriate for serious, professional, academic, official, or unfamiliar social situations.

Practice 12

> “The report should be written in **formal English**.”

「這份報告應該使用**正式英語 / 較正式的語體**撰寫。」

Practice 13

> “His email sounded too **formal** for a close friend.”

「他寫給好友的電郵語氣顯得**太正式、太拘謹**。」

formal language = 用詞、句式和語氣較正式、較少口語化，適合專業、學術或官方場合的語言

7. **formal writing** (正式寫作) — 正式 / 學術 / 專業文體的

Closely related to #6, but especially important for learners.

Practice 14

> “Avoid slang in **formal writing**.”

「在**正式寫作**中應避免使用俚語。」

Practice 15

> “Contractions are sometimes avoided in very **formal writing**.”

「在非常**正式的書面語**中，有時會避免使用縮寫形式。」

formal writing = 適合學術、商業、官方或專業用途的較嚴謹書面表達方式

Examples often avoided in highly formal writing:

- * slang;
- * very casual expressions;
- * excessive conversational fillers.

8. **formal speech/tone** (說話方式) — 正式的；較拘謹的

Practice 16

> “She used a more **formal tone** when speaking to the directors.”

「她跟董事說話時用了較**正式、較莊重的語氣**。」

Practice 17

> “The conversation became increasingly **formal**.”

「那段對話逐漸變得**正式而拘謹**。」

formal tone = 語氣較莊重、有禮、克制，較少隨意或親密感

9. **formal clothes/dress** (服裝) — 正裝的；禮服式的

A major everyday meaning.

Practice 18

> “The invitation says **formal dress** is required.”

「邀請函寫明需要穿著**正式服裝 / 禮服**。」

Practice 19

> “He wore a dark suit to the **formal dinner**.”

「他穿著深色西裝出席那場**正式晚宴**。」

formal dress/clothing = 適合婚禮、晚宴、頒獎禮或其他正式場合的服裝，而不是休閒服

10. **formal occasion** (正式場合) — 禮儀要求較高的場合

Practice 20

> “A wedding can be a very **formal occasion**.”

「婚禮可以是一個禮儀要求很高的**正式場合**。」

Practice 21

> “This suit is suitable for **formal occasions**.”

「這套西裝適合在**正式場合**穿著。」

formal occasion = 需要遵守較正式服裝、言行或禮儀規範的社交 / 官方場合

11. **formal behaviour/manners** (行為 / 禮儀) — 拘謹的；講究禮節的

This sense emphasizes conventional social behaviour.

Practice 22

> “He is quite **formal** with people he has just met.”

「他面對剛認識的人時比較**拘謹、講究禮節**。」

Practice 23

> “Their relationship remained polite but **formal**.”

「他們的關係一直有禮，但比較**正式而不親近**。」

formal behaviour = 言行較克制、遵守社交禮節，沒有太多隨意或親密感

This can sometimes imply emotional distance.

12. **formal relationship (關係)** — 正式但較疏離的

Practice 24

> “Their working relationship was professional and **formal**.”

「他們的工作關係很專業，但亦比較**正式而疏離**。」

Practice 25

> “He maintains a **formal relationship** with his former manager.”

「他跟前經理維持一種**正式而不太親近的關係**。」

formal relationship = 雙方按照禮節或角色互動，但關係不隨便、不親密

13. **formal education (教育)** — 正規教育；有制度的教育

This is a very important established meaning.

Practice 26

> “She received very little **formal education**.”

「她接受的**正規學校教育**很少。」

Practice 27

> “Much of his knowledge came from experience rather than **formal education**.”

「他的很多知識來自實際經驗，而不是**正規教育**。」

formal education = 由學校、大學或其他認可教育機構按照課程制度提供的正規教育

Contrast:

> informal learning

= 非正式學習 / 日常經驗中的學習

14. **formal training** (正式培訓) — 系統性的正規訓練

Practice 28

> “She had no **formal training** in public speaking.”

「她沒有接受過公開演講方面的**正規培訓**。」

Practice 29

> “Most employees receive **formal training** before using the equipment.”

「大部分員工在使用設備前都會接受**正式而有系統的培訓**。」

formal training = 按照有組織的課程、標準或專業制度進行的訓練

15. **formal qualification** (正式資格) — 認可資格；正式學歷 / 證書

Practice 30

> “The job does not require any **formal qualifications**.”

「這份工作不要求任何**正式學歷 / 認可資格**。」

Practice 31

> “Experience can sometimes be more valuable than **formal qualifications**.”

「實際經驗有時比**正式資格證明 / 學歷**更有價值。」

formal qualification = 由認可機構頒發、正式證明某人教育或專業水平的資格

16. **formal organization/structure** (組織 / 結構) — 正式建立的；有明確制度的

Practice 32

> “The group has no **formal structure**.”

「這個團體沒有明確的**正式組織架構**。」

Practice 33

> “A **formal management structure** was introduced as the company grew.”

「隨著公司擴張，公司建立了一套**正式管理架構**。」

formal structure = 角色、權責、層級或規則被明確訂立的組織方式

17. **formal rule/system** (規則 / 制度) — 明確界定並按規則運作的

Practice 34

> “The club has no **formal rules**.”

「這個會社沒有任何**正式訂立的規則**。」

Practice 35

> “They introduced a **formal system** for evaluating performance.”

「他們建立了一套**正式的績效評估制度**。」

formal system/rule = 被清楚定義、記錄並按既定規則運作的制度 / 規則

18. **formal logic/system** (邏輯 / 系統) — 形式化的；依明確符號規則建立的

This is an established academic meaning.

Meaning: Based on precisely defined symbols, structures, and rules rather than ordinary language or intuitive reasoning.

Practice 36

> “The argument can be represented using **formal logic**.”

「這個論證可以用**形式邏輯**表示。」

Practice 37

> “Computer scientists often work with **formal systems**.”

「電腦科學家經常研究**形式系統**。」

****formal = 以明確定義的符號、結構及推理規則建立，而不是依賴一般自然語言直覺的****

This is common in:

- * logic;
- * mathematics;
- * computer science;
- * linguistics.

19. ****formal proof (數學 / 邏輯證明) — 嚴格形式證明****

Practice 38

> “The claim requires a ****formal proof****.”

「這項主張需要一個****嚴格的形式證明****。」

Practice 39

> “The software can verify a ****formal mathematical proof****.”

「該軟件可以驗證****形式化的數學證明****。」

****formal proof = 按照明確定義的邏輯規則逐步推導出的嚴格證明****

This is more specialized than your passage meaning, but useful for educated learners.

20. ****formal analysis (形式 / 結構分析) — 分析形式或結構的****

In language, literature, art, and design, ****formal**** can refer to the ****form or structure itself**** rather than content.

Practice 40

> “The essay includes a ****formal analysis**** of the poem.”

「這篇文章包含對詩歌****形式和結構的分析****。」

Practice 41

> “The critic focused on the painting’s ****formal qualities****.”

「評論家集中分析這幅畫的**形式特徵 / 構圖、線條和結構特點**。」

****formal = 與作品的形式、結構、構圖或組織方式有關，而不是主要討論內容或主題****

21. ****formal garden/design (園林 / 設計) — 規整而對稱的****

A useful design-related meaning.

Practice 42

> “The palace is surrounded by ****formal gardens****.”

「宮殿四周是****布局規整、講究對稱的庭園****。」

Practice 43

> “The room has a very ****formal layout****.”

「這個房間的布局非常****規整、講究對稱和秩序****。」

****formal design/garden = 按明確幾何、對稱或規則化布局設計的，而不是自然隨意的****

22. ****formally = in an official way (正式地) — 正式地；按程序地****

Practice 44

> “The decision was ****formally announced**** on Monday.”

「這項決定在星期一****正式公布****。」

Practice 45

> “She was ****formally appointed**** as team leader.”

「她被****正式任命****為團隊主管。」

****formally = 按照正式程序、官方方式或機構規則地****

23. ****formally = in a serious/polite style (以正式方式) — 正式地；莊重地****

Practice 46

> “He was dressed ****formally**** for the event.”

「他為活動穿得很****正式****。」

Practice 47

> “She spoke ****formally**** to the senior managers.”

「她跟高層經理說話時語氣很****正式、莊重****。」

****formally = 以符合正式場合禮節、服裝或語言規範的方式****

24. ****formality = official procedure/requirement (正式手續) — 正式程序；手續****

Practice 48

> “Signing the document is an important ****formality****.”

「簽署文件是一項重要的****正式程序 / 手續****。」

Practice 49

> “There are a few legal ****formalities**** to complete.”

「還有幾項法律上的****正式手續****需要完成。」

****formality/formalities = 為使某件事正式有效而需要完成的規定、程序或手續****

25. ****a formality = something certain but still officially required (形式而已) — 例行公事；形式上的程序****

A very important separate use.

Practice 50

> “The final interview is largely a ****formality****; they have already decided to hire her.”

「最後的面試基本上只是****例行公事 / 形式上的程序****；他們已經決定聘請她。」

Practice 51

> “Once everyone agreed, the vote became a **mere formality**.”

「所有人都同意後，投票便只剩下一個**形式程序**。」

a formality = 結果實際上已經確定，但仍因制度、禮節或程序要求而需要完成的步驟

Common:

> **a mere formality**

= 純粹形式上的程序 / 例行公事

26. **formality** = formal social behaviour (拘謹 / 禮節) — 正式禮節；拘謹

Practice 52

> “There was too much **formality** in their conversation.”

「他們的談話中有太多**拘謹和正式禮節**。」

Practice 53

> “The manager preferred friendliness to unnecessary **formality**.”

「經理較喜歡親切交流，而不是不必要的**拘謹禮節**。」

formality = 人際互動中較正式、遵守禮節而不隨意的程度

27. **formalities** = official/social procedures before something can proceed (必要程序) — 手續；例行程序

Usually plural.

Practice 54

> “After completing the **formalities**, we entered the building.”

「完成所有**正式手續**後，我們進入了大樓。」

Practice 55

> “Let’s get the **formalities** out of the way first.”

「我們先把那些**必要程序 / 例行手續**處理好吧。」

formalities = 某項活動、交易或程序正式開始 / 完成前必須處理的規定步驟

28. **formalize/formalise** = make something official (使正式化) — 正式確立；正式訂立

Formalize is American spelling.

Formalise is British spelling.

Practice 56

> “The two companies decided to **formalize their partnership**.”

「兩家公司決定**正式確立合作關係**。」

Practice 57

> “The agreement was later **formalized in writing**.”

「這項協議後來以書面方式**正式確立**。」

formalize an agreement/arrangement = 把原本較非正式的安排變成正式、明確並具有制度 / 法律效力的安排

29. **formalize** = give something a clear structure/rules (使制度化 / 結構化) — 制度化；訂立明確規則

A broader sense than simply making something “official.”

Practice 58

> “The company decided to **formalize its hiring process**.”

「公司決定把招聘程序**制度化**，訂立明確流程。」

Practice 59

> “The team needs to **formalize its decision-making process**.”

「團隊需要把決策流程**正式制度化 / 建立明確規則**。」

****formalize a process/system = 把原本較隨意或不明確的做法轉化為有清晰規則、步驟和結構的制度****

30. ****formalization/formalisation (正式化 / 制度化) — 正式確立 ; 形式化過程****

Practice 60

> “The ****formalization**** of the partnership took several months.”

「合作關係的****正式確立****花了幾個月時間。」

Practice 61

> “The organization benefited from greater ****formalization**** of its procedures.”

「該機構受益於程序更進一步的****制度化和規範化****。」

****formalization = 把某種關係、制度、程序或概念變得正式、明確、有規則的過程****

31. ****informal = casual / relaxed (非正式的 ; 輕鬆的) — 非正式的 ; 隨意的****

The main opposite of ****formal****.

Practice 62

> “We had an ****informal discussion**** after the meeting.”

「會議後我們作了一次****非正式的輕鬆討論****。」

Practice 63

> “The event was quite ****informal****, so people wore casual clothes.”

「那個活動相當****輕鬆、不太正式****，所以大家都穿便服。」

****informal = 不受正式程序、服裝、語體或禮節嚴格限制的 ; 較隨意的****

32. ****informal language (非正式語言) — 口語化的 ; 日常的****

Practice 64

> “This expression is too **informal** for an academic report.”

「這個表達對學術報告來說太**口語化 / 不夠正式**。」

Practice 65

> “Friends often use **informal language** with each other.”

「朋友之間通常會使用較**日常、隨意的語言**。」

informal language = 適合日常對話、朋友間交流等場合的較輕鬆口語表達

33. **informal arrangement/agreement** (非正式安排 / 共識) — 未正式確立的

Practice 66

> “They had an **informal agreement** to share the office.”

「他們有一個**非正式共識**，共同使用辦公室。」

Practice 67

> “The schedule was based on an **informal arrangement**.”

「這個時間表是根據一項**未正式記錄的安排**制定的。」

informal agreement/arrangement = 雙方已有共識，但沒有經正式文件、制度或法律程序確立的安排

Important distinction: **formal vs informal**

This is the core contrast.

formal

usually involves one or more of:

- * established rules;
- * official procedures;
- * professional conventions;

- * serious tone;
- * social etiquette;
- * structured organization.

informal

usually means:

- * casual;
- * relaxed;
- * unofficial;
- * less structured;
- * conversational.

Compare:

> **a formal presentation**

= 有準備、有結構、在專業場合進行的正式簡報

> **an informal presentation**

= 較輕鬆、較少儀式或規範的分享 / 簡報

Neither automatically means better.

They are appropriate for different situations.

Important distinction: **formal vs official**

These overlap, but they are not identical.

official

usually means:

authorized by an organization, government, or responsible authority

> “The company issued an **official statement**.”

「公司發表了**官方聲明**。」

formal

often means:

following established procedures, conventions, or serious professional style

> “She submitted a **formal complaint**.”

「她**正式提出投訴**。」

Something can be formal without being “official.”

For example:

> **formal clothes**

are not “official clothes.”

So:

official = 由權責機構正式認可 / 發出的

formal = 符合正式程序、場合、結構或禮儀規範的

Important distinction: formal vs professional

These can overlap strongly in workplace contexts.

formal

focuses on:

- * level of ceremony;
- * rules;
- * structure;
- * style;
- * lack of casualness.

professional

focuses on:

- * appropriate workplace behaviour;
- * competence;
- * standards;
- * responsible conduct.

Compare:

> “The presentation was **formal**.”

= 簡報形式較正式、嚴謹。

> “The presentation was **professional**.”

= 簡報表現符合專業標準、質素良好。

A presentation can be:

> professional but informal

For example, a relaxed internal team presentation can still be highly professional.

Important distinction: **formal vs serious**

formal

= follows convention, structure, or official style

serious

= not joking/light-hearted; important or severe

> “It was a **formal meeting**.”

= 會議形式正式。

> “It was a **serious meeting**.”

= 會議討論的事情很重要 / 嚴肅。

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **formal vs polite**

Being **formal** can involve politeness, but they are different.

polite

= showing good manners and respect

formal

= following a more official, conventional, or less casual style

You can be:

> **informal but polite**

For example:

> “Hi Sarah, thanks for your help!”

is informal but perfectly polite.

So:

polite = 有禮貌

formal = 正式、較拘謹 / 按正式規範

Important distinction: **formal language vs difficult language**

Formal language is not automatically complicated.

A sentence can be:

> clear + simple + formal

For example:

> “Please submit the completed form by Friday.”

This is formal enough for many professional contexts, but not difficult.

So:

formal language = 適合正式場合的語體

not:

formal language = 一定要用很艱深的字

This is particularly relevant to your presentation passage because you deliberately:

> “cut out anything too technical or complicated.”

A presentation can therefore be both:

> **formal and clear**

without being complicated.

Important distinction: formal education vs education generally

education

is broad and can include learning from:

- * school;
- * work;
- * family;
- * experience;
- * self-study.

formal education

specifically means:

> organized education through recognized institutions and structured programmes

So someone may have:

> little formal education

but still be highly knowledgeable through experience and self-study.

Important distinction: formality = procedure vs formality = mere formality

Compare:

a required formality

> “Signing the document is a legal **formality**.”

= 法律要求的正式手續

****a mere formality****

> “The interview is just a ****formality****.”

= 面試只是形式，結果基本已經決定

The same noun can therefore refer either to:

1. an actual official procedure;
2. a procedure whose outcome has essentially already been decided.

Important distinction: ****formalize vs formal****

****formal****

describes a state:

> “They have a ****formal agreement****.”

「他們已有一份正式協議。」

****formalize****

describes the change into that state:

> “They decided to ****formalize the agreement****.”

「他們決定把協議正式確立下來。」

So:

****formal = 已經正式的****

****formalize = 使某事變得正式 / 制度化****

British/American spelling note

American English

- * formalize
- * formalized
- * formalization

British English

Both **formalise / formalised / formalisation** are standard British forms.

The **-ize** spellings are also accepted by some British style systems, including Oxford style.

For learners, the key point is to stay consistent within one piece of writing.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **formal** family includes several highly useful branches:

- * **formal presentation/event/meeting** = 正式、有組織、符合專業場合規範的
- * **formal approval/announcement** = 經正式程序批准 / 公布的
- * **formal complaint/request/warning** = 按正式程序提出 / 發出的
- * **formal agreement/contract** = 正式確立並具有明確效力的
- * **formal procedure/process** = 按既定規則進行的程序
- * **formal language/style** = 適合正式、專業、學術或官方場合的語體
- * **formal writing** = 較嚴謹的正式書面表達
- * **formal tone** = 較莊重、拘謹的語氣
- * **formal dress** = 正式服裝 / 禮服
- * **formal occasion** = 禮儀要求較高的場合
- * **formal behaviour/relationship** = 講究禮節、較不隨意 / 較疏離
- * **formal education** = 正規教育
- * **formal training** = 正規、有系統的培訓
- * **formal qualification** = 正式認可的學歷 / 資格
- * **formal structure/system** = 有明確規則、角色及架構的制度
- * **formal logic/system** = 依明確符號及規則建立的形式系統
- * **formal proof** = 嚴格依規則推導的形式證明
- * **formal analysis** = 分析作品形式 / 結構的
- * **formal garden/design** = 規整、對稱、有明確布局的
- * **formally — officially** = 正式地 / 按程序地
- * **formally — manner** = 以正式、莊重方式
- * **formality — procedure** = 正式手續 / 程序
- * **a mere formality** = 結果已定、只剩形式的程序
- * **formality — social behaviour** = 拘謹 / 正式禮節
- * **formalities** = 必要手續 / 例行程序
- * **formalize/formalise** = 使正式確立 / 制度化
- * **formalization/formalisation** = 正式化 / 制度化過程
- * **informal** = 非正式、隨意的

* **informal language** = 日常、口語化的語言
 * **informal agreement** = 未經正式程序確立的共識
 * **informally** = 非正式地 / 隨意地
 * **informality** = 非正式、輕鬆、不拘禮節的特質

The important thing is not to split every collocation into a separate lexical sense.

Most uses grow from a few broad concepts:

- > **according to official procedure**
- > **according to convention or etiquette**
- > **structured rather than casual**
- > **systematically defined**
- > **concerned with form/structure**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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formal presentation/event/meeting	按照正式場合的規範，以有組織、較嚴謹和專業方式進行，而不是輕鬆隨意的
formal — officially recognized	經機構、組織或權責人士按照正式程序確認、批准或公布的
formal complaint/request/warning	按照既定制度正式記錄、提出或發出的投訴、要求或警告
formal agreement/contract	經正式程序確立、通常有明確條款或制度 / 法律效力的協議
formal procedure/process	按照機構預先訂立的正式規則和步驟進行的
formal language/style	用詞、句式及語氣適合專業、學術、官方或嚴肅場合，而不是口語隨意的
formal writing	適合學術、專業或官方用途的較嚴謹書面表達方式
formal tone	語氣較莊重、有禮、克制而不隨意親密的
formal dress	適合婚禮、晚宴、頒獎禮等正式場合穿著的服裝
formal occasion	需要遵守較正式服裝、禮節或言行規範的場合
formal behaviour	遵守社交禮節、言行較拘謹而不隨便的
formal relationship	按角色及禮節互動，但較不親近、較不隨意的關係
formal education	由學校、大學等認可教育機構按課程制度提供的正規教育
formal training	按有組織的課程、標準或專業制度進行的正規訓練
formal qualification	由認可機構正式頒發、證明教育或專業水平的資格 / 學歷

	formal structure/organization	角色、權責、層級和規則被清楚訂立的正式架構
	formal rule/system	被清楚定義、記錄並按照既定規則運作的制度
	formal logic/system	以明確定義的符號、結構和推理規則建立的形式系統
	formal proof	按照嚴格邏輯規則逐步推導出的形式證明
	formal analysis	主要分析作品的形式、結構、構圖或組織方式
	formal garden/design	依明確幾何、對稱和規則化布局設計的
	formally — official	按正式程序、官方方式或制度規則地
	formally — manner	以符合正式場合禮節、服裝或語言規範的方式
	formality — procedure	為使某件事正式有效而必須完成的程序或手續
	a mere formality	結果實際上已基本確定，但仍需完成的形式 / 例行程序
	formality — social style	人際互動中較正式、拘謹及講究禮節的程度
	formalities	活動、交易或程序開始 / 完成前必須處理的正式手續
	formalize/formalise	把原本較非正式的安排、關係或程序正式確立 / 制度化
	formalization/formalisation	把關係、制度或程序轉化為正式、有明確規則形式的過程
	informal — casual	不受正式程序、服裝、語體或禮節嚴格限制的；較隨意的
	informal language	適合日常對話或熟人之間使用的較口語、較輕鬆語言
	informal agreement	雙方已有共識，但沒有經正式文件、制度或法律程序確立的安排

For your original passage

> “One of the most challenging things I have ever done was giving a ****formal presentation**** in English at a company event last year.”

The exact meaning is:

****formal = 按照公司正式場合的專業規範，以事先準備、有結構、較嚴謹而不隨意的方式進行的****

Therefore:

> ****a formal presentation****

= ****「一場在專業正式場合中，經過準備並按照較嚴謹結構進行的簡報」****

In your particular situation, ****formal**** is supported by the fact that:

- * the audience consisted of about two hundred colleagues;
- * several senior managers were present;
- * you were representing your team;
- * you were reporting on a work project;

- * the presentation was prepared in advance;
- * the situation carried professional expectations.

So the key mapping is:

****formal presentation = 正式、專業、有預先準備和清晰結構，而不是隨意分享式的簡報****

The most important learner point is that ****formal**** does not simply equal one Chinese word 「正式」 in every context:

> ****formal presentation****

> = 正式而有結構的簡報

> ****formal complaint****

> = 按程序正式提出的投訴

> ****formal education****

> = 正規教育

> ****formal dress****

> = 正式服裝 / 禮服

> ****formal language****

> = 正式語體

> ****formal proof****

> = 形式 / 嚴格邏輯證明

> ****a mere formality****

> = 結果大致已定、只剩形式上的程序

The unifying idea is broadly ****greater reliance on established rules, structure, convention, or recognized procedure rather than casual or spontaneous practice****, but the natural Traditional Chinese expression must change according to context.